

IT 2018 Overview

GOOGLE DRIVE

The market saves its electronic documents on Google Drive.

What is not working:

- **Overall use and accessibility of files in Drive is difficult** in our type of business where we have staff, customers and growers needing to access information.
- **Users without a Gmail associated email are not able to edit docs** stored in Drive. We must share allow link access to that document and allow editing, which makes the document less secure than allowing specific users.
- **We are concerned that our business information is stored in the cloud.** We have backed up our drive files on Dropbox but haven't done so in a while. Need a better back up.

WIFI NETWORK

We currently have CenturyLink wifi. Comcast currently does not offer service to our building but a few tenants in our building have inquired. We have a two year contract with CenturyLink that is up in November 2019. We pay \$140/month. We invested \$750 in industrial wifi boosters in our office and in the warehouse.

We have two networked computers and one networked printer. We generally have 3-4 laptops, 2 printers, 1 ipod and 4-10 personal phones all on our network. Plus the sublease tenant also uses our wifi.

What is not working:

- Our experience with CenturyLink has been horrible - **our wifi is slow and inconsistent**, and customer service is pretty awful.
- Laptops, warehouse printers and Square ipod run on wifi. We experience regular interruption of connectivity, especially on our Square ipod, which **delays customer checkout**.

QUICKBOOKS

We use Quickbooks Premier Pro and have 5 user licenses which is the maximum under that software level.

We use Quickbooks to:

- Invoice and track customer sales
- Send and track purchase orders
- All accounting functions
- Financial reports
- Sales reports

I personally think that Quickbooks works fine for invoicing. It can handle the number of items we have and we are able to generate a lot of different reports which we can customize. It takes some time to learn and staff need to be very careful when invoicing items but I think this would be the case with any invoicing system due to the complexity of our business.

What is not working:

- **Need more users** - at least 7 users, which bumps us into a different level of software (Enterprise)
- **Server is clunky** - would like to upgrade to remote hosting (we had remote hosting for 2 years - wifi needs to be in tip top shape though). A lot of staff time has been spent navigating IT issues related to maintaining the server.
- **Credit card processing is not integrated with Quickbooks.** Must be manually reconciled with Square every day.

CREDIT CARD PROCESSING

We have been using an iPod to process credit cards with the Square app. We love how user friendly Square is, and the customer service has been good.

What is not working:

- The **iPod has connectivity issues** specific to that device.
- We **do not have enough credit card processing devices** so staff would use their phones to process credit cards.
- **Square is not integrated with our Quickbooks.** We need to manually reconcile credit card transactions daily.

ORDERS PAGE

The orders page on our website is currently a simple field based system where anyone (including people who are not wholesale customers) are able to enter

whatever items they are seeking. It is not linked to currently availability and does not provide pricing. We do not take payment on this site (nor do we want to).

Once an order is placed, the market receives a generated email with the order information. The customer also receives an email with the specifics of the order that was just placed. It confirms that we received the order but it does not confirm that we are able to supply the product - that comes in another email.

All order information is then entered or copied into a Google Drive spreadsheet.

We also send a cost estimate to the customer, which requires staff to enter the order into an estimate form in Quickbooks.

What is not working:

- **Orders page is open to anyone on our website.** For unfamiliar names, we need to check Quickbooks to see if they are a customer and communicate back to them if they are not.
- **Orders page is not connected to availability.** This creates extra work for staff to communicate with customers about product we will not have.
- **Orders page does not automatically generate an estimate.** Creating estimates is one of the most time consuming pieces of our orders system. Customers really appreciate having this service.
- **Information placed through the orders site does not auto populate our Google Drive orders spreadsheet.**

PURCHASE ORDER SYSTEM

Current we track our orders and purchase orders in a Google Drive spreadsheet. Purchase orders are generated and sent through Quickbooks. Purchase orders are sent to growers by customer order, not by product. Most POs are sent to growers the week before pick up.

What is not working:

- **The number of POs sent by staff is very time consuming.** On a busy summer week, more than 900 purchase orders are sent to growers. The communication back and forth for these POs with staff, growers and customers takes 3 full time staff in the summer.
- **The number of POs that growers receive and need to organize is unwieldy for large volume growers.** Because we send POs by customer and not by

product, growers have to look through many POs to get a sense of volume for each crop. Growers must respond to POs within 48 hours and in the high season some growers receive 100+ POs in a week. This pulls them away from harvesting in the field.

- POs are typically emailed to growers a week prior to customer pick up. Sometimes that is **not enough time to communicate back to customers** about shorts or subs.

AVAILABILITY

Currently we ask our growers to complete a weekly Fresh Sheet that lists all crops available for sale on their farm for the following week. Staff assemble each growers' availability into one document and emails that out to wholesale customers every Friday.

We also ask growers to list all the crops they grow throughout the year in a Product Log, and provide updates about the progress of those crops frequently.

Growers provide a written or email packing slip for all product brought to the market for sale.

What's not working:

- **Our availability is not connected to our orders page.** Customers end up ordering product that is not available or take staff time asking questions about availability.
- **Growers are listing and updating their crop list in 3 different places for the Fresh Sheet, Product Log and packing slips.** Seems like we could organize this information in one location and code it appropriately for weekly availability and packing slips.
- Growers submit packing slips on paper and in email which makes it **difficult for staff to see at a glance what is coming and search by item.** This would help with product i.d. and correcting sales reports.

Misc Items

Conference call system - We currently use a not so great speaker for our conference calls and would appreciate a suggestion for either a better phone/speaker or video conferencing.